

and all these with a minimum of fuss. An ideal application could be defined as 'one with various functionalities, fancy features and a very easy-to-use interface'.

VLC: As we start talking about music players, the first name that comes to mind is VLC. It is the most extensively used player across devices. The biggest surprise is that it is open



Figure 1: VLC1

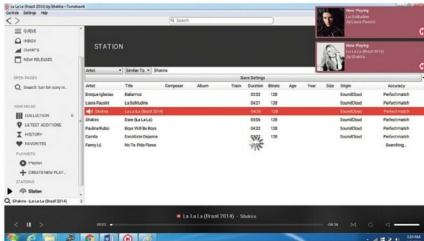


Figure 2: Tomahawk2

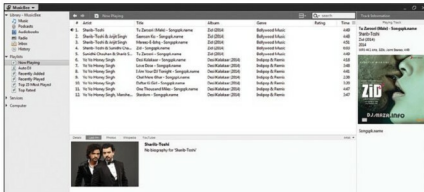


Figure 3: Musicbee

source and free. From being a simple MP3 and video formats (limited number) player, VLC has evolved into a complete audio/video tool that can play anything, including DVDs and ISO formats, runs on all platforms, provides features like HD-recording, live streaming, APIs, browser plug-ins and much more.

Tomahawk: If you socialise with music, then Tomahawk is the answer for you. It comes with a newly designed interface and flawless, innovative social features. Tomahawk marries a traditional app structure with the modernity of our 'on-demand' culture. It can browse and play music from local libraries as well as online services like Spotify, Grooveshark and SoundCloud. In its latest release, it adds Google Play Music and Beats Music to its roster.

Even though it sounds a little cumbersome, playing music on Tomahawk is as simple as telling it the track title and the artist, and it will find a high-quality version for you from sources enabled in it.

It enables you to share music using Jabber, and it has an in-built messaging system to share playlists and tracks, etc.

MusicBee: I have seen many people calling this the musical Swiss Army knife because it can do anything and everything with music.

It is not just a music player but a complete music manager. To start with basic applications, it lets you play and arrange your music on the basis of what you like. At the same time, there are small pans which show the currently-playing track along with all the possible data related to it including lyrics of the track. Another panel lets you access the Internet to find audio books, Internet radio, podcasts, etc.

The player itself provides a 10-band equaliser for sound control along with digital signal processing, and supports almost all possible music formats along with a CD ripping facility.